Happenings in Handmade

A CCI initiative

June 2024

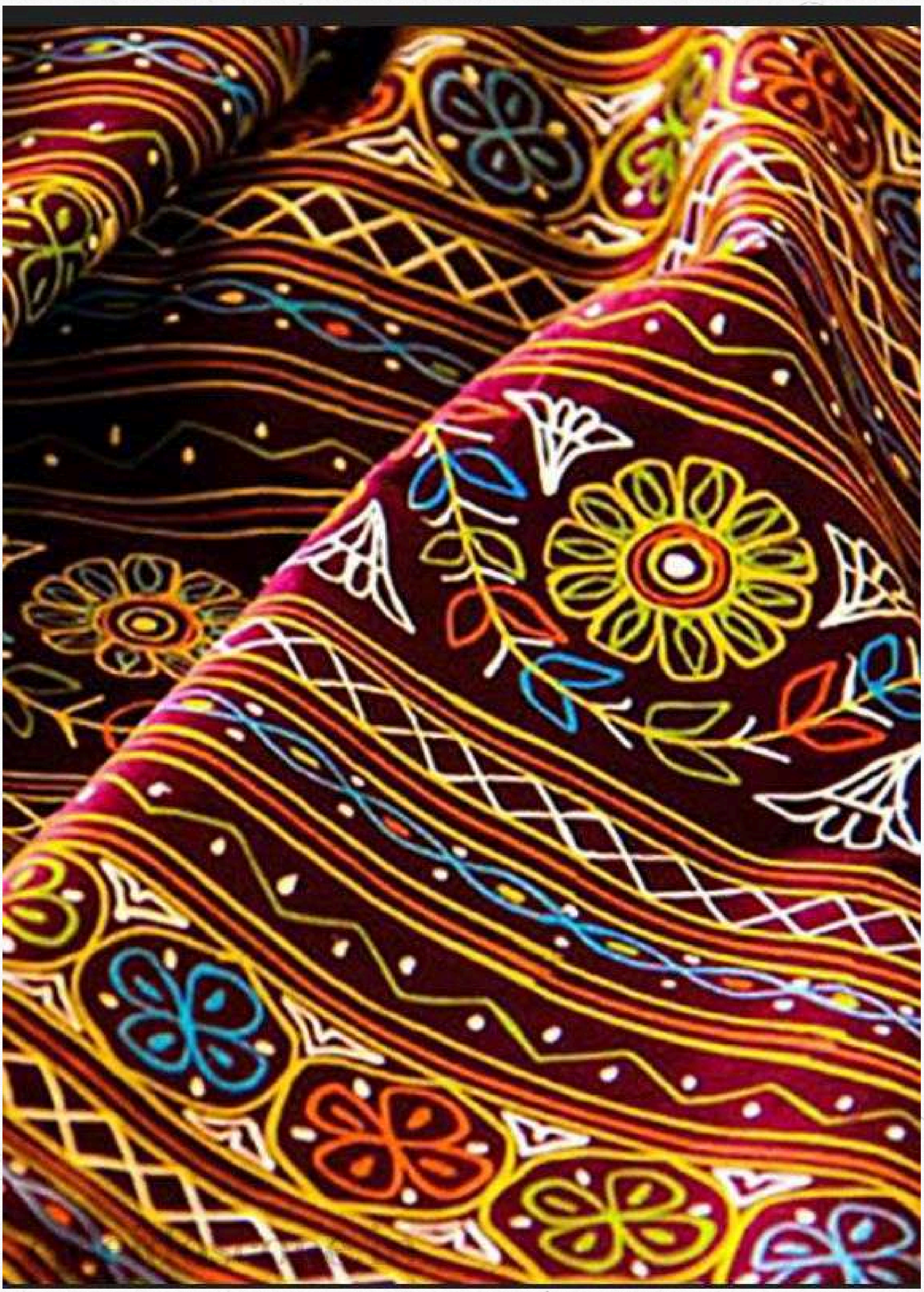
ROGAN ART



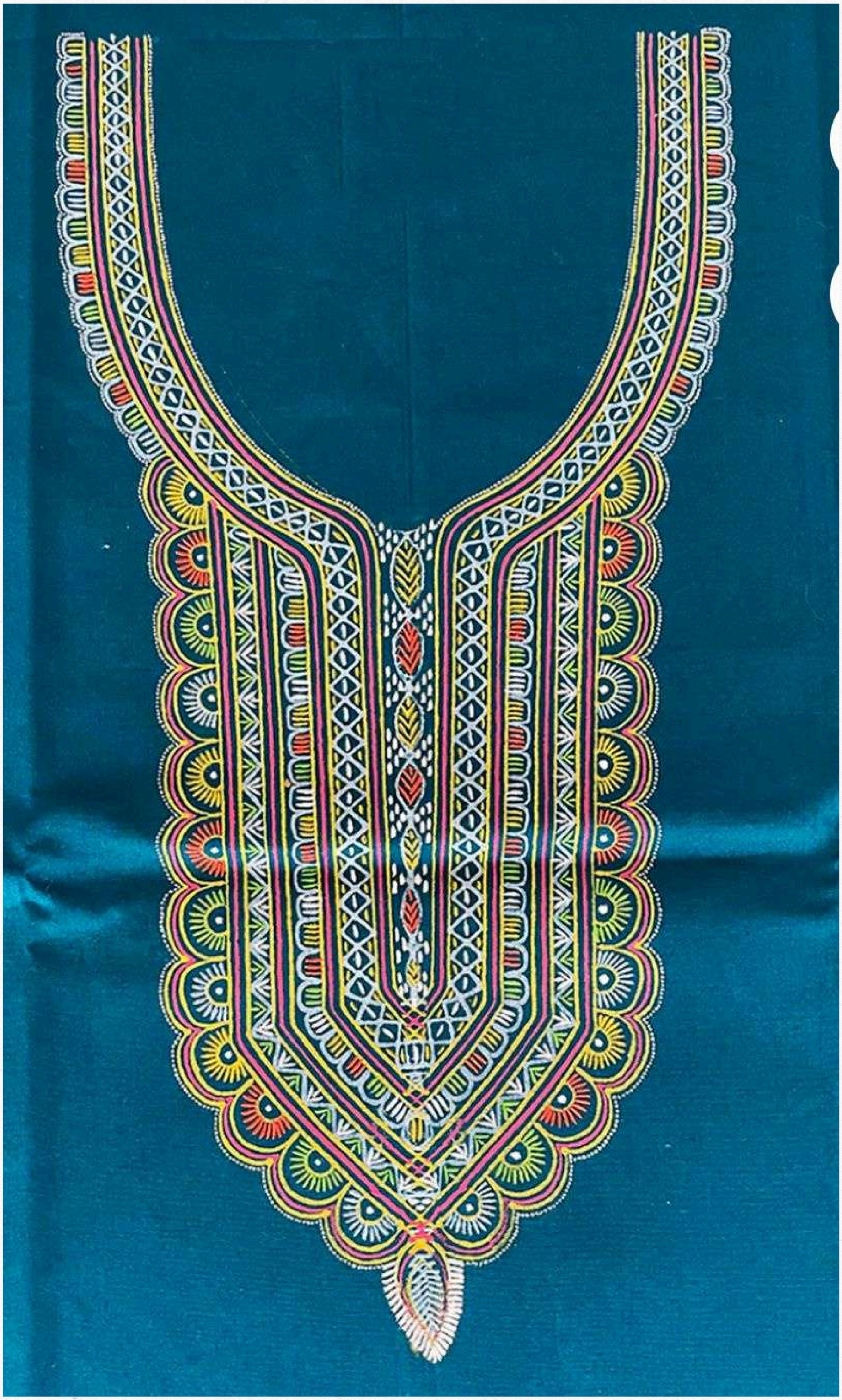


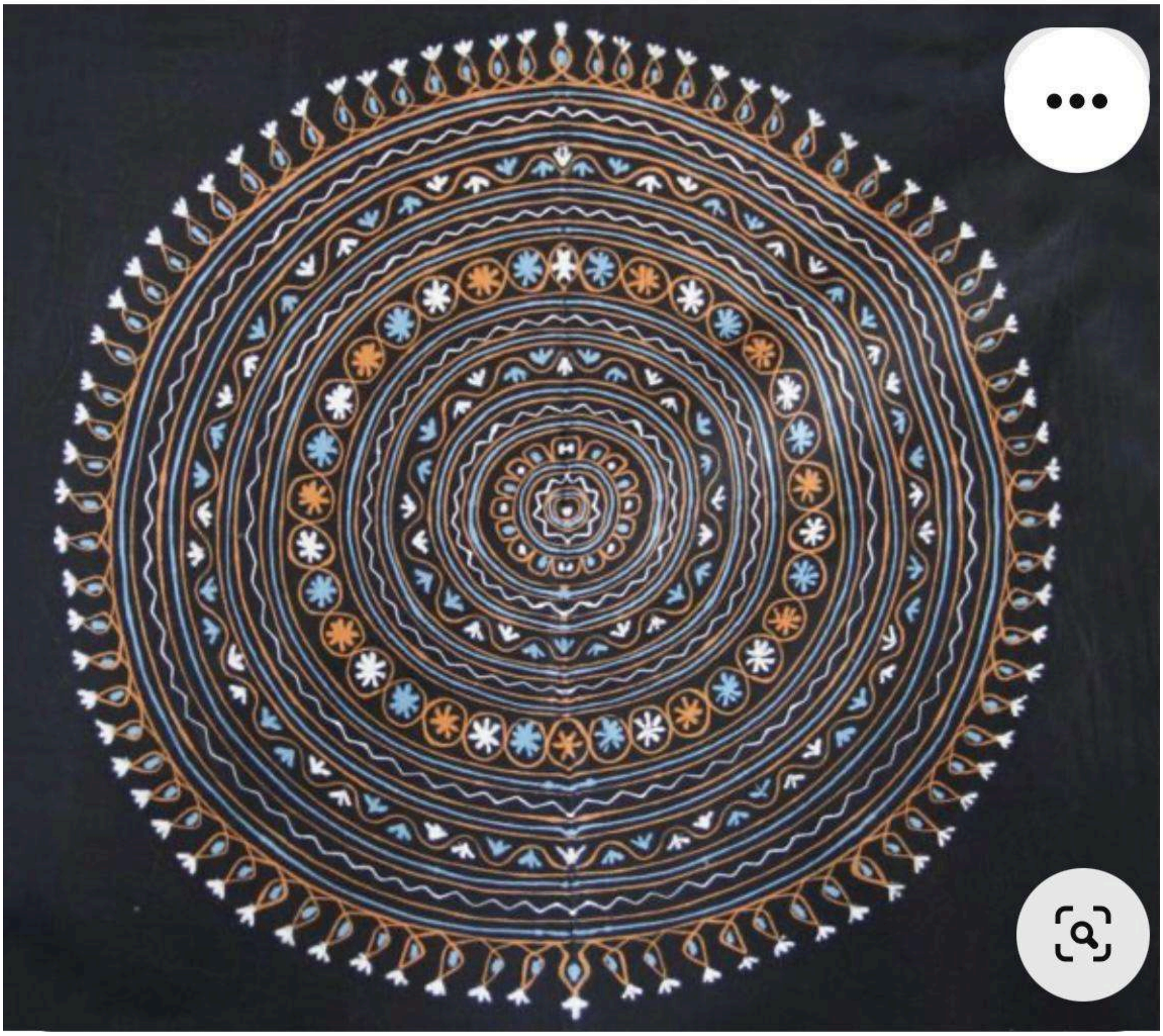
Originating from Gujarat's Kutch region in the 16th century, Rogan art was introduced by the Khatri community migrating from Sindh.

Its Persian-rooted name, "Rogan," signifies "oil-based," highlighting the use of castor oil. Over time, it became integral to Kutch's cultural fabric, adorning garments and household items with intricate motifs and vibrant hues.









Artists heat castor oil and mix it with natural pigments to create a colourful palette.

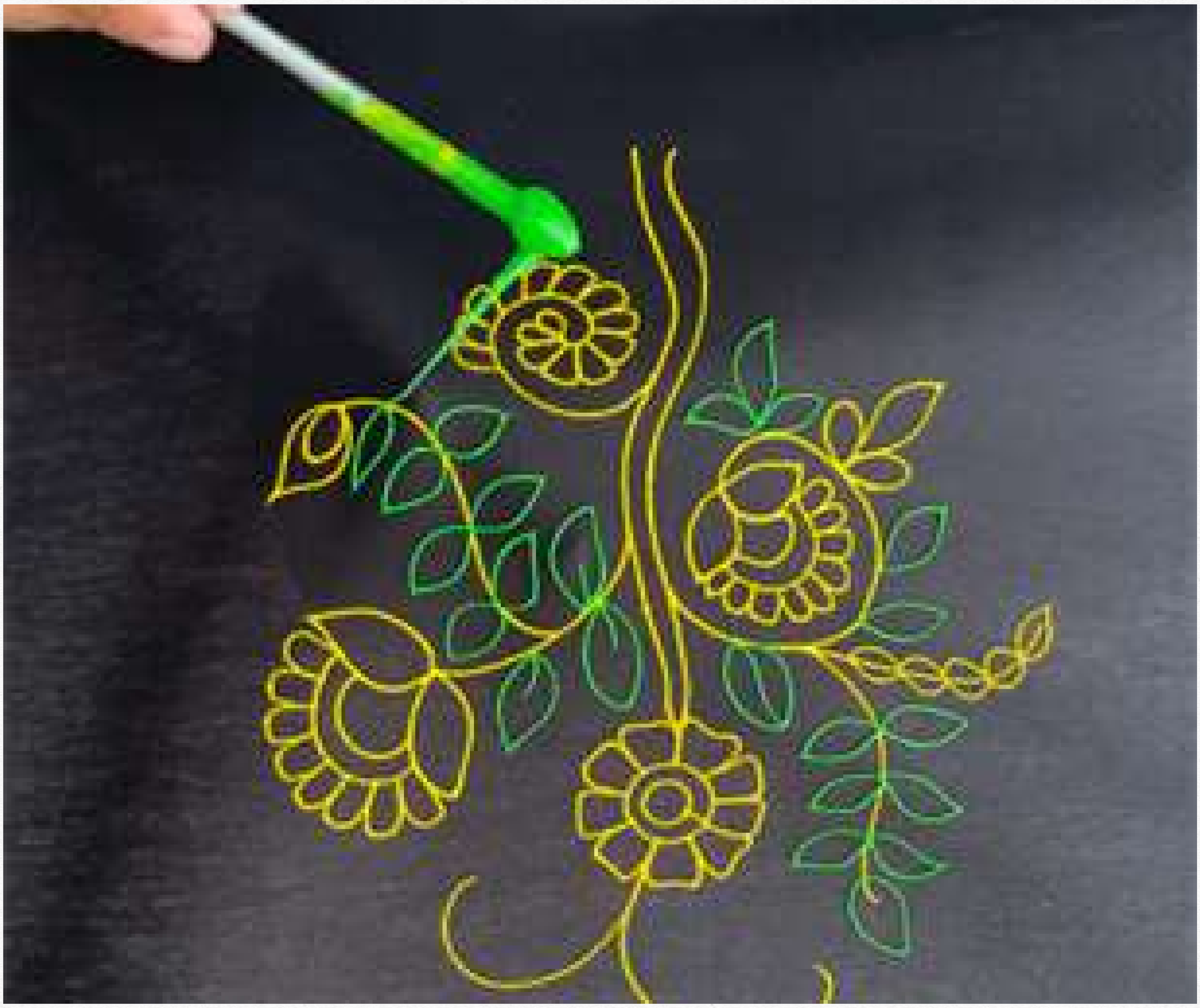


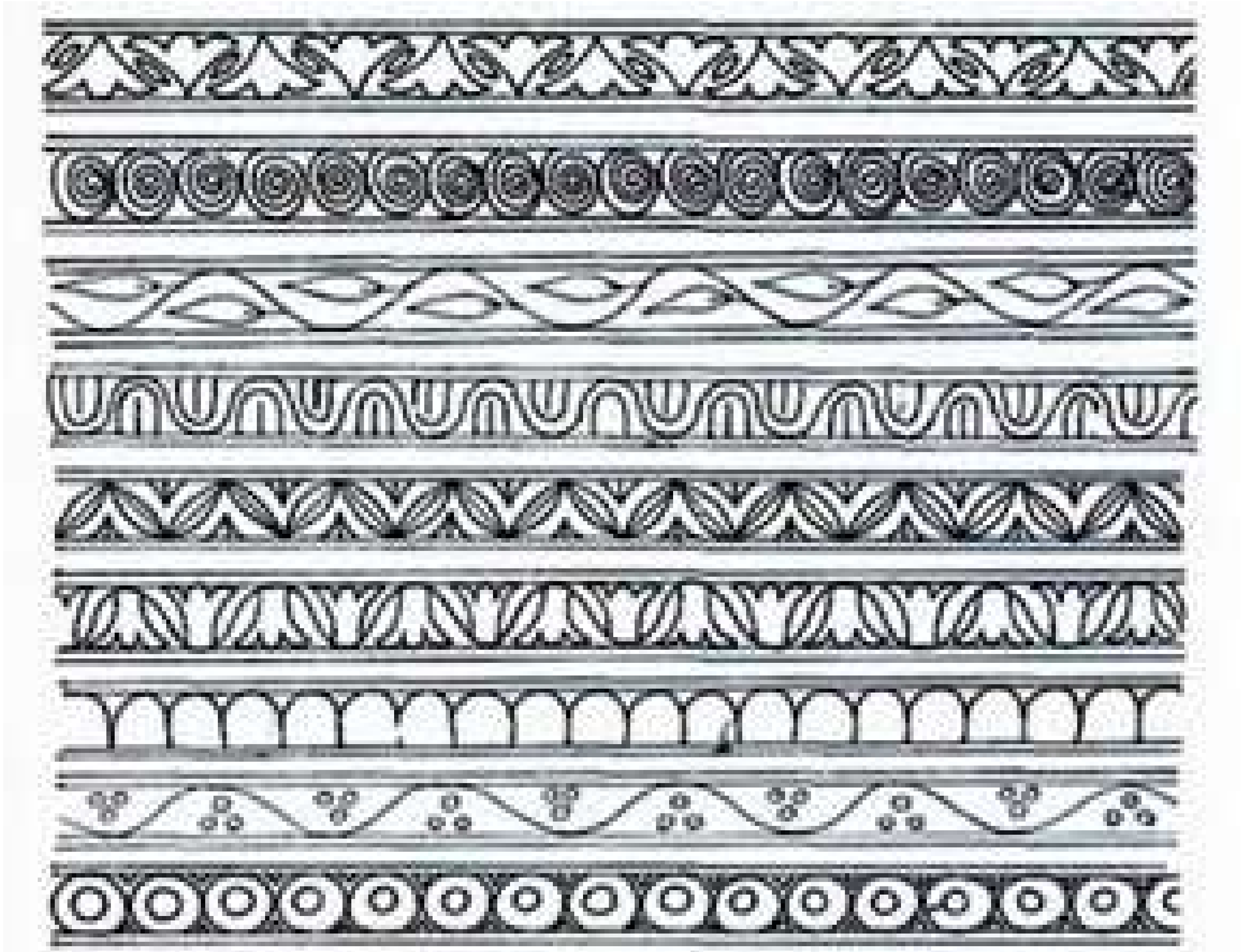






They then pick up a small amount of the coloured oil on the palm of their hand, warming it with their body heat to make it malleable. With practiced precision, they transfer the oil onto fabric, creating intricate patterns freehand.





Traditional Phul-vel designs in Rogan art, NIrona (A.Pandya & A.Vishwakarma 2008)


Getty/indianexpress.com

This tactile approach results in textiles that embody both craftsmanship and cultural heritage.

Abdul Gafur Khatri and his family, pioneers of Rogan art in Kutch, have garnered multiple national awards for their exceptional craftsmanship and dedication to preserving the tradition.





Beyond mastering the craft, they've pioneered inclusivity, teaching both men and women in their community, making Rogan art a source of livelihood and cultural pride.

The gift of Rogan art from Prime Minister Narendra Modi to many heads of state showcases the art's ability to keep up with modern trends.



